

THE MANAGER'S CHECK-IN GUIDE

A 5-Minute Mental Health Pulse Check
You don't need a psychology degree to notice when someone's struggling. You just need five minutes and the right questions.



Important: This guide helps you start a conversation, not provide treatment. You are not a therapist, and you're not expected to be one. Your job is to notice, ask, and connect people with the right support.



WHY THIS MATTERS RIGHT NOW

Summer takes a toll your team might not say out loud. Long hours, heat, short-staffed shifts, too little recovery time add up fast, and burnout doesn't always look like burnout. Sometimes the warning sign is trouble focusing on the floor or a short fuse in a meeting. A quick check-in can catch what a routine safety review might miss.



5 CONVERSATION STARTERS

Use these when something feels off, even if you can't name why.

- 01** "You've seemed a little off lately. Everything okay?"
- 02** "How are you handling things outside of work right now?"
- 03** "I noticed you've seemed more tired/quiet/on edge lately. How are you doing?"
- 04** "Is there anything making this week harder than it needs to be?"
- 05** "What would actually help right now, even something small?"



Tip: Ask, then stop talking. Practice active listening, let the silence do some of the work.



SIGNS WORTH A CHECK-IN

- Sudden changes in mood, focus, or reliability
- Increased safety incidents or near-misses
- Withdrawal from coworkers or usual routines
- Uncharacteristic irritability or exhaustion
- Comments about feeling overwhelmed or "done"



WHEN TO ESCALATE



If someone mentions hopelessness, self-harm, or not wanting to be here anymore, stop trying to solve it yourself.



Stay calm and stay with them if it's safe to do so.



Follow your organization's crisis-response procedure and contact the appropriate HR, EHS, or emergency response lead.



If there's any immediate danger, call 911.



Share the crisis resources below directly with the employee.

CRISIS AND SUPPORT RESOURCES



988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline

- Call or text 988
- Free, confidential, available 24/7



SAMHSA National Helpline

- 1-800-662-4357 (1-800-662-HELP)
- Free, confidential treatment referral and information service, 24/7/365, for individuals and families facing mental health or substance use challenges

YOU DON'T HAVE TO HAVE THE ANSWER.
YOU JUST HAVE TO **START THE CONVERSATION.**